

HSBC Job Simulation — Deep-Dive Playbook

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For: Janak · **Role:** Corporate & Institutional Banking (CIB) — Graduate Insight Programme · **Stage:** Job Simulation (Cappfinity) · **Prepared:** 10 August 2026.

This is a complete briefing on the stage you were just invited to: the whole process from the moment you click the link, how HSBC and the platform see and score you on their end, how people get screened out, the integrity/anti-cheating measures, exactly what HSBC's AI rules allow, and the full bank of questions you could be asked. It is a preparation guide, not an answer key — and by design it cannot be, because the assessment scores authenticity (see §5).

One-line strategy: this is a *strengths-based, authenticity-checked* simulation with a *human making the final call*. You win by being accurate on any data/numerical work, genuinely and consistently yourself on the behavioural/strengths parts, and structured + commercially aware on the video and email. Do **not** perform an "ideal banker" — the platform is built to catch that.

I did not open your assessment link. Your `apitake.cappassessments.com` link is a personal, single-use assessment — opening it could consume or corrupt your attempt. Everything here comes from independent research.

How to read this briefing

Every substantive claim is labelled: **OFFICIAL** (HSBC or Cappfinity primary source) · **CORROBORATED** (3+ independent sources) · **ANECDOTAL** (single/second-hand) · **INFERRED** (my reasoning). Citations are numbered `[n]` → the Source list at the end.

Sourcing limits you should weigh: the richest candidate sources — Reddit, Wall Street Oasis, The Student Room, Glassdoor, YouTube — are login/bot-gated (HTTP 403 / captcha), so candidate quotes are recovered via search snippets, not full pages. Cappfinity's own feature pages are JavaScript-rendered, so some Cappfinity claims are confirmed by page title/snippet, not full body text. The strongest anchors are HSBC's own careers pages and Cappfinity's product/whitepaper pages.

Executive summary

- **The stage.** Your invite is HSBC's **Job Simulation**, delivered on **Cappfinity's** platform (`apitake.cappassessments.com`), with a prep portal at `hsbc.preparationplus.com`. This

confirms Cappfinity — not HireVue — runs the current video stage **OFFICIAL** — your invite domains^[14]. It is a ~30-minute, ~15-question, 4-"micro-exercise" simulation mixing **recorded video answers, situational-judgement ranking, personality profiling, and a written email**, wrapped in a realistic "day in the business" storyline **CORROBORATED** ^{[17][19][22]}.

- **Untimed but time-recorded.** You have your invited window (your email says **10 days**) and it is "not timed" (~30 min typical), **but the platform records how long you take, and that can feed the decision** **CORROBORATED** ^{[23][20]}. Individual video answers are timed (~2 min prep / ~2 min record, usually no re-record) **CORROBORATED** ^[22].
- **How they score you.** Cappfinity builds a **multi-dimensional profile** — strengths fit + aptitude accuracy + a consistency/authenticity check — and reads it **against a success benchmark for this specific role and intake**, not a single right answer **CORROBORATED** ^{[25][23]}. Video can be **AI-assisted or human-reviewed at the employer's choice** **OFFICIAL** ^[9], but **HSBC states the platform makes no automated hiring decisions — all decisions are made by the hiring team** **OFFICIAL** ^[1]. Assume a human watches your video.
- **The model underneath.** You are scored against **HSBC's four values: We value difference · We succeed together · We take responsibility · We get it done** ("We take responsibility" is flagged as the most important) **OFFICIAL** ^{[1][4]}.
- **How you get screened out.** The named failure patterns: inconsistent/exaggerated "gamed" answers; numerical errors; rambling or running out of prep time; generic answers not tied to HSBC/CIB; weak commercial awareness; not answering the actual question; technical/recording failures **CORROBORATED** ^{[23][25]}.
- **Cheating measures.** Cappfinity markets a **multi-layer defence**: Camera-On recording, Copy-Prevention (no paste), Time-Recorded latency, and an **Integrity Dashboard that flags likely AI use** **OFFICIAL** ^{[11][12][13]}. §6 lists the honest-candidate behaviours that could *accidentally* trip these and how to avoid them.
- **AI rules — the important nuance.** HSBC **explicitly permits AI for preparation and support** (research, rehearsing, organising/drafting ideas where the final work is genuinely yours) but **forbids using AI to generate responses during live or recorded interviews** and forbids submitting anything you "cannot personally explain, validate, or replicate if asked" **OFFICIAL** ^[1]. Translation: fine to prep and to help draft/tidy the **written email** if the final words are yours; **never read AI-generated text into the camera**.
- **What CIB is.** After HSBC's 2024 reorganisation (effective 1 Jan 2025), **Corporate & Institutional Banking = the former Global Banking & Markets + Commercial Banking outside the UK/Hong Kong + Western markets** — a markets-led, financing-focused wholesale bank **CORROBORATED** ^{[4][47][48]}. §9 gives the commercial-awareness themes that matter.

1. The whole process, from the second you click the link

OFFICIAL / CORROBORATED unless noted.

- 1. Before you start — the prep portal.** Register at the Candidate Zone / **Preparation Plus** (hsbc.preparationplus.com) and work through its practice material first; HSBC also references a "Practice Zone" to familiarise yourself with the format before the live sitting **OFFICIAL** ^{[1][14]}. Cappfinity's own guidance: *"complete some of the practice questions supplied before you begin, and start the assessments only when you are sure you can give them your undivided attention"* **OFFICIAL** ^[1].
- 2. Access.** You open the assessment via the tokenised link in your email (the **ApiTake** "packaged assessment" on cappassessments.com) within your stated window — your email says **10 days**. The window is set per candidate; "10 days" is what *your* email says, not a universal standard **CORROBORATED** window; the exact number is per-invite ^[23].
- 3. Tech + environment check.** You need a **laptop/desktop (no mobiles), webcam + microphone, a modern browser (Chrome/Firefox/Edge/Opera, or current Safari on supported macOS), and a stable connection** **OFFICIAL** ^[8]. Your email adds **calculator, pen, paper** — a strong signal there is numerical/analysis work in this sitting, so have them ready.
- 4. The mandatory "Video Set-Up Tile."** Cappfinity's device documentation is explicit: *"each video assessment will contain a Video Set Up Tile, which must be completed first. This will enable you to test your camera and microphone along with completing a Warm-Up question before you start your actual assessment"* **OFFICIAL** ^[8]. HSBC says you can *"do practice runs as many times as you like"* **OFFICIAL** ^[1]. **The warm-up is unscored — use it to fix framing, lighting and audio and to rehearse the record flow.**
- 5. The tiled homepage.** The assessment presents as an **interactive homepage of clickable "tiles,"** each a themed exercise you open in turn **CORROBORATED** ^{[22][30]}. Inside a tile you consume material (a video/audio briefing, an email from a "manager," data tables, charts, a news article) and then respond by **video, by ranking options, or by typing** **OFFICIAL** — HSBC lists "audio or video content, mock emails, data tables and graphs, or written articles" and "short written and video responses" ^[2].
- 6. Pausing / returning.** Cappfinity's Preparation Hub FAQ says *"most untimed assessments will allow you to return to the assessment later if you have been interrupted or need more time,"* while recommending you complete each in one sitting **OFFICIAL** via snippet ^[14]. **Caveat:** a single **video recording, once started, is timed and generally cannot be paused or re-recorded** — treat each video answer as one live take **CORROBORATED** ^[22]. Whether a half-finished video *tile* can be resumed is unverified — assume "one sitting per tile" **INFERRED** .

7. **Submission and result.** You submit on completion; HSBC's email says they'll be in touch **within a few days**, though candidate reports of ~2-week (occasionally 5+ week) waits exist **OFFICIAL** email; CORROBORATED timing varies^[23]. HSBC does **not** give detailed feedback at this stage **ANECDOTAL** ^[39].

2. What's inside — the exercises

CORROBORATED ^{[17][19][22]} The Job Simulation is ~15 questions across **4 micro-exercises**, ~35 minutes:

1. **Video Set-Up** — 1 unscored practice/warm-up video question (camera/mic test + rehearse the format).
2. **SJT on an article** — ~2 questions. You read/watch a news article about a **fictitious event** (a "G7 Summit" scenario is named repeatedly across sources) and respond (video + ranking); assesses how you'd *start a research project* **CORROBORATED** ^{[17][28]}.
3. **Fictitious company analysis** — ~6 questions. Details/news about a fictional company; **research priorities, decision-making, logical presentation**; mixes SJT + personality profiling **CORROBORATED** ^{[17][28]}.
4. **Further analysis + email** — ~6 questions. Deeper analysis of the same company, framed as **presenting findings to potential investors**; mixes SJT, video, and the **free-text email** **CORROBORATED** ^{[17][19]}.

Response formats you'll meet: - **Recorded video** — ~3–5 questions; **≈2 min prep, ≈2 min record** each (one source says 30 s / 3 min); no live interviewer; typically no re-record

CORROBORATED ^[22]. - **Situational judgement** — usually **rank 5 options 1 (most likely) → 5 (least likely)**; some versions rate each option effective → counterproductive, or pick the single best action — prepare for all three **CORROBORATED** / one ANECDOTAL ^{[23][27]}. - **Personality / work-style** — two-sided preference scales; and a Cappfinity signature: strengths are probed **twice — what you'd do vs what you'd most/least enjoy** (a "strength" = competence **and** energy) **CORROBORATED** ^[24] ^[25]. - **Written email ("free text")** — reply to "*an email from an HSBC colleague or manager, as if you're already on the job,*" capped at **≤3,000 characters** (aim ~2,500–3,000) **CORROBORATED** ^[19] ^[22]. - **Numerical / data** — reading tables, graphs, pie charts and a colleague's email across several tabs; percentage change, trends, ratios, and integrating two data sources at once (this is why the invite asks for a calculator) **CORROBORATED** ^{[27][18]}.

Note on exact names/counts: these come from prep vendors reverse-engineering the test, and HSBC tailors content by business area, so **your exact tiles may differ** **INFERRED**. Sources also sometimes blur this Job Simulation with the earlier Immersive Assessment you already passed **CORROBORATED** disagreement^[23].

3. How they see and rank you — the scoring model

The core mechanism **OFFICIAL** / **CORROBORATED**^{[16][25][23]}: Cappfinity is a **strengths-based** publisher. It does not mark most of this like a right/wrong test; it builds a **profile** and compares it to an **employer-defined "success profile" and a standardised norm group**. A strength is defined as behaviour that is *authentic and energising* and drives performance — so it scores **whether your natural pattern fits what the CIB role rewards**, not whether you guessed a "correct" personality answer **OFFICIAL**^[16].

The four things being measured and combined **CORROBORATED**^{[25][23][20]}:

Dimension	What it is	How it's judged
Strengths fit	Your preference/behaviour profile vs the strengths this role rewards	Profile-matched to the role/intake benchmark — "same answers can fit one division and fail another"
Aptitude accuracy	Embedded numerical/verbal/data questions	Objective right/wrong; accuracy is a hard filter
Consistency / authenticity	The same strengths probed repeatedly	Inconsistent or exaggerated answers are penalised; a coherent, authentic profile scores higher
Time taken	Latency per item + overall	"Both the accuracy of your answers and the time you took... will be taken into account"; speed can break ties

Video and written answers are judged on **competency evidence, structure, communication, commercial reasoning and authenticity** **CORROBORATED**^{[23][25]}. Cappfinity's video product offers the employer **"AI-assisted scoring... or human-led evaluation when nuance matters most"** **OFFICIAL**^[9] — but the governing statement for HSBC is decisive: **"The AI-based platform does not make any automated decisions in the hiring process. All decisions will be made by our**

hiring team" **OFFICIAL** ^[1]. So: **a human reviews your video and email; AI may help triage/flag, but a person decides.**

Pass/fail or ranked? In practice this is a **gate against a benchmark** between stages (Immersive → Job Simulation → Assessment Centre / Virtual Experience Day) — you clear the threshold or you don't, and the profile also informs later interviews **CORROBORATED** ^{[23][3]}. A single Student Room summary claims "*only 10% pass the online job simulation*" — **treat as folklore, not official** **ANECDOTAL** ^[41]. Whether HSBC recruiters see a numeric rank is unverified **INFERRED**.

Marking criteria — what a high vs low response looks like

Higher-scoring **CORROBORATED** ^{[23][25]}: authentic and internally consistent throughout; sound, values-aligned practical judgement on SJTs; accurate numeracy; video answers that are **structured (beginning–middle–end), specific, calm and to the point** with visible commercial awareness; written answers that are **concise, professional, well-structured and grounded in the materials**, with the right tone for the recipient.

Lower-scoring / screened-out **CORROBORATED** ^{[23][25]}: inconsistent or exaggerated ("gamed") strengths answers; numerical mistakes; rambling or running out of prep time; generic answers not tied to HSBC values or CIB; weak commercial awareness; not actually answering the question; unprofessional or unclear writing; technical/recording failures. Note a **"slow but correct"** answer can still be marked down because timing feeds the score **CORROBORATED** ^[23].

4. The model underneath — HSBC's values, mapped

OFFICIAL ^{[1][4]} You are scored against HSBC's **four current values** (adopted ~2021, current post-reorg):

1. **We value difference** — seek out and respect perspectives different from your own; inclusive collaboration across cultures.
2. **We succeed together** — trust, connect and support others; collaborate across boundaries.
3. **We take responsibility** — high standards, accountability, sound judgement, speaking up on risk/conduct. *Flagged as the most important* — fitting for CIB, which lives on trust and risk **OFFICIAL** ^[1].
4. **We get it done** — decisive, steady progress; continuous improvement.

Ignore the older wording ("Dependable / Open / Connected") that some prep sites still use — it's HSBC's pre-2021 branding **CORROBORATED** disagreement ^[31].

How the exercises map to what's being probed (the reasoning, so you can lead with the right behaviour on camera):

Exercise	Primarily probes
SJT on the article / research project	<i>We get it done</i> + <i>We take responsibility</i> — how you scope and start work under ambiguity
Fictitious company analysis	<i>We take responsibility</i> + judgement — prioritisation, sound analysis, ethics
Presenting to investors / email	<i>We succeed together</i> + communication — clarity, tone, stakeholder awareness
Personality / strengths items	authenticity + consistency — feeds the whole profile
"Working with others" scenarios	<i>We value difference</i> + <i>We succeed together</i> — collaboration across cultures/seniority

5. How to get screened out — and how not to

Synthesised from candidate reports and Cappfinity's stated methodology **CORROBORATED** [23] [25]:

- **Numerical errors.** The classic killer. Units, percentage change, misreading a chart, rushing. Use the pen/paper/calculator; double-check.
- **Gaming the strengths/SJT.** Trying to give the "perfect banker" answer produces an inconsistent profile the consistency check is designed to catch, and it scores *worse* than honesty. Answer as you genuinely would.
- **Rambling / no structure on video.** Use the ~2-min prep to plan a beginning–middle–end; answer the actual question; stop when done.
- **Generic answers.** "Why HSBC/CIB" with no specifics, or examples not tied to a value, read as low-effort. Anchor to HSBC's values, CIB's business, and real personal examples.
- **Weak commercial awareness.** For CIB, not being able to reference a recent macro/market development is a visible gap (§9).
- **Timing extremes.** Very fast (looks pre-prepared) or very slow (timing feeds the score) both hurt — work at a genuine, steady pace.
- **Technical failure.** Untested webcam/mic, weak Wi-Fi, leaving the tab. Do the Video Set-Up warm-up and complete each tile in one focused sitting.

Retakes/reapplication: no retake within a cycle for underperformance (only genuine, documented technical failures reported quickly are re-issued); you can reapply in a future cycle **CORROBORATED** [20], from the vendor ecosystem **ANECDOTAL** [39]. HSBC gives no feedback at this stage.

6. Integrity & anti-cheating measures (framed so you don't trip them by accident)

Cappfinity markets a "**multi-layer defence**" (**prevention, deterrence, detection**) — the title of its own white paper on ChatGPT and assessment integrity **OFFICIAL** [13]. Confirmed features (existence and headline wording verified; full mechanics not public):

Measure	What it does	Honest-candidate accidental trigger → how to avoid
Camera-On Assessment OFFICIAL [11]	Records you via webcam during the assessment	Looking off-screen, long silences, another face/voice in frame → looks like reading a script or getting help. Sit alone, well-lit, look at the camera; glancing at the on-screen question is fine.
Copy Prevention OFFICIAL [11]	Restricts copy/paste in written answers	Pasting text (even your own notes) → flag. Type your email answer live in the box.
Time-Recorded CORROBORATED [20]	Records latency + total time; can feed the decision	Implausibly fast, or long unexplained gaps → steady natural pace; one focused sitting per tile.
Integrity Dashboard / AI-use flagging OFFICIAL [12]	"Highlights behaviour indicative of AI model use" to recruiters	Over-polished, generic, boilerplate writing → can read as AI <i>even if you wrote it</i> . Use your own voice + concrete personal specifics.
Device/IP (typical of the platform class) INFERRED	Logs device/connection metadata	VPN/proxy, switching devices/networks mid-way → looks evasive. Normal home connection, one device, no VPN.

What HSBC's terms prohibit and the stakes: HSBC's hiring emphasises "*Authenticity, integrity, and transparency*" and treats fabrication/misrepresentation as grounds to withdraw you; you must be able to "**personally explain, validate, or replicate**" anything you submit if asked **OFFICIAL** [1]. Read the on-screen instructions/declaration before you start — those are the binding rules for your sitting. (Per your ask, this briefing does **not** cover techniques to defeat detection.)

7. The AI rules — read this carefully

Your invite says AI "for support" is fine "but make sure your answers are still true to you." HSBC's **Application hints and tips** page sets the exact boundary **OFFICIAL** ^[1]:

Acceptable AI use: research HSBC, its values and roles · help *structure* your CV/application "provided the content accurately reflects your own experience and skills" · prepare by "*practising answers to common questions*" · "*assist with organising your thoughts or drafting ideas, ensuring the final submission is genuinely your own.*"

Unacceptable AI use: "*fabricate or exaggerate skills, qualifications, or work experience*" · "**generate responses during live or recorded interviews**" · "*misrepresent your motivations, capabilities, or achievements*" · submit work you "*cannot personally explain, validate, or replicate if asked.*"

What this means in practice for the Job Simulation: -  Use AI *now, to prepare*: research CIB and current affairs, rehearse the question bank in §8, structure your "why HSBC/CIB" story, get feedback on practice answers. -  For the **written email**, using AI to help *organise or tidy* your thinking is within the rules **only if the final wording is genuinely yours and you could reproduce the reasoning** — and remember Copy-Prevention means you'll be **typing it live**, and the Integrity Dashboard flags AI-sounding text, so write in your own voice. -  **Do not** use AI to generate what you say in the **recorded video** answers — that's explicitly prohibited and the camera-on + timing + AI-flag layers are the enforcement. - Safe test: *could I explain and reproduce this answer, live, if HSBC asked me to?* If not, don't submit it.

8. The question bank — everything they could ask (CIB-weighted)

Labels: **CORROBORATED** = reported by 3+ / multiple candidate channels · **ANECDOTAL** = single genuine candidate report · **INFERRED** = generic prep-list, not confirmed from an HSBC candidate. **Treat these as practice prompts to build your material, not a leaked paper** — the actual wording varies and authenticity is scored.

Highest-confidence real Job-Simulation prompts (candidate-reported)

1. Why HSBC? / Why Corporate & Institutional Banking (or commercial/corporate banking)?
/ Why finance? **CORROBORATED** ^{[34][37][31]}

2. You're joining a new team and only know one person / there are several senior colleagues you've never met — how do you introduce yourself and interact? **CORROBORATED** — the most-reported job-sim video prompt^{[41][44]}
3. Read the supplied article/newsletter, then write an email to a colleague arguing why HSBC should (or shouldn't) invest in a particular project. **CORROBORATED** — the main written task^{[41][19]}
4. What do you do in your free time? **CORROBORATED**^[32]
5. Tell me about a recent macro event / news story and how it affected markets. **ANECDOTAL** — strong Markets/CIB signal^[38]
6. Tell me about a recent deal, or a company/industry you find interesting, and why. **CORROBORATED**^[37]
7. Tell me about a time you worked in a diverse team / showed leadership. **ANECDOTAL** / **CORROBORATED**^{[44][32]}
8. Introduce yourself / tell me about yourself. **CORROBORATED** — the warm-up/opener^[32]

A. Motivation / "why"

Why HSBC · Why CIB/this division · Why finance/banking · Why this programme · Where do you want your HSBC career to go (5–10 yrs) · What can you add / why hire you over others

CORROBORATED for the first four; **ANECDOTAL/INFERRED** for the last^{[34][31][32]}.

B. Competency / behavioural (use STAR)

Joining a new senior team (see #2) · a time you led / led by example · a time you worked in a diverse team and ensured collaboration · a decision made without all the information · a time something didn't go to plan · being open to a different perspective that changed your approach · handling conflict / disagreeing with a leader · adapting to significant change · delivering on a commitment despite obstacles **mix of CORROBORATED and INFERRED**^{[44][31]}. **Markets/CIB-specific situational (genuinely reported):** voicing/defending an opinion to a senior person (an MD) · a friend asks your advice on an ethical dilemma · someone keeps interrupting in a meeting — how do you handle it **ANECDOTAL**^[38].

C. Ethics / integrity

Suspecting a colleague of unethical behaviour · raising a concern or flagging a risk when it's uncomfortable · ethical-dilemma SJTs in the ranking section **INFERRED** / **CORROBORATED** for the SJT format^{[32][23]}.

D. Strengths-based (Cappfinity style)

What are your strengths / what will you bring · your greatest weakness and how you're improving · **what energises you** · do you prefer working alone or in a team · how would others describe you · what demotivates you **CORROBORATED** for strengths/weakness/team; **INFERRED** for the rest^{[32][25]}.

E. Commercial awareness (highest priority for CIB)

A recent macro event and its market impact · a recent deal / an industry you find interesting · how you keep up with financial news · risks and opportunities facing HSBC · an HSBC product or two / what HSBC does · (business-interview examples) today's FT headline; "what will the world look like in 2050 and what does it mean for HSBC" **ANECDOTAL** / **INFERRED**^{[38][37][33]}.

F. The written email

Reply to a manager/colleague's email "as if on the job," ≤3,000 chars — often *should HSBC invest in project X?* using a supplied article/data **CORROBORATED**^{[19][41]}.

Prep-list only (rehearse, but NOT confirmed HSBC prompts)

The 30-item MockQuestions "HireVue" set and Indeed's 37-question set are largely **US-retail/customer-service flavoured** (e.g. "pillars of good customer service," "building relationships with customers," "background checks") and are prep guesses, not what CIB grads report — use them for general practice only **INFERRED**^{[32][33]}.

How to answer well (frameworks — build your own words)

- **Video, any question:** use the prep time to jot 3 bullets → **structure: point** → **example (STAR)** → **link back to HSBC value/CIB**. Keep to ~90 s–2 min, look at the camera, one clear message per answer.
- **"Why HSBC / CIB":** one genuine personal driver → one specific about HSBC/CIB (the East–West network, the 2024 CIB creation, transaction banking/markets, a recent deal or its Asia strategy) → what you'll contribute. Specific beats generic.
- **Behavioural: STAR** (Situation, Task, Action, Result) — HSBC itself recommends STAR **OFFICIAL**^[1]. Pick examples that each showcase a different value.
- **Strengths items:** answer honestly and consistently across the whole test; the effort is in knowing your genuine strengths beforehand, not in guessing.
- **Written email: acknowledge** → **prioritise/triage** → **recommend with reasoning from the data** → **clear next step/ownership**. Professional, concise, short paragraphs or bullets, right tone for the recipient. Type it live.

9. CIB context & commercial awareness (so you sound like you belong)

What CIB is **CORROBORATED** ^{[4][47][48]}: In HSBC's 2024 reorganisation (announced 22 Oct 2024, effective 1 Jan 2025 under CEO Georges Elhedery), HSBC moved to **four businesses — Hong Kong; UK; Corporate & Institutional Banking; International Wealth & Premier Banking**. **CIB = the former Global Banking & Markets + Commercial Banking outside the UK & Hong Kong + Western markets**, led by Michael Roberts, organised around an **Eastern (Asia-Pacific, Middle East) / Western (UK, Europe, Americas)** split.

What CIB does **OFFICIAL** ^[4]: a *"markets-led, financing-focused"* wholesale bank spanning **Banking (coverage/advisory for large corporates & institutions), Global Trade Solutions (trade & receivables finance), Global Payments Solutions (cross-border payments, cash & liquidity), Markets & Securities Services (FX, rates, credit, equities, custody), and Global Research**. Clients: large corporates, financial institutions, governments/public sector, institutional investors.

Commercial-awareness themes to have a view on **INFERRED** from CIB's mix + current affairs ^[49]:
- **Interest rates / monetary policy** — net interest income, financing demand, market volatility. - **Geopolitics & the East–West split** — the whole reorg is a bet on navigating US–China tensions, trade/supply-chain shifts; Asia (esp. Hong Kong/mainland China) vs Western markets. - **HSBC's strategy** — pivot toward Asia and wealth; exits from some Western retail markets; reported moves to streamline commercial + investment banking to cut costs. - **Transaction banking** — trade finance and real-time cross-border payments (GTS/GPS). - **ESG / sustainable & transition finance** — a stated financing and research focus. - **Markets** — FX and rates volatility, capital-markets/advisory activity.

Prepare **1–2 recent stories** you can discuss with a genuine view (what happened, why it matters to HSBC/CIB, the risk and the opportunity). A CIB insight reviewer's advice: *"be aware of current affairs so that you can mention them in video interview questions to display that you are sufficiently commercially aware"* **ANECDOTAL** ^[45].

The programme itself **CORROBORATED** ^{[3][45]}: the Graduate Insight Programme is a short (~≤1 week; CIB version ~4 days) insight/work-experience programme — sessions with MDs and interns, case studies across CIB, networking — and it is a **feeder**: do well and HSBC fast-tracks you to a virtual experience day for the internship/graduate programme. This Job Simulation is the **screening gate** into that experience.

10. Your ~10-day prep plan

- **Days 1–2 — Foundations.** Read this briefing. Learn HSBC's four values with a personal example for each. Read the CIB careers page and get the reorg/structure straight (§9).
- **Days 3–4 — Commercial awareness.** Pick 2 stories (rates, geopolitics/Asia, an HSBC development) and write a "what/why-it-matters/risk/opportunity" note for each. Skim the FT/Bloomberg on HSBC and CIB.
- **Days 5–6 — Strengths + behavioural.** List 6–8 genuine strengths with STAR stories, each mapped to a value. Rehearse the §8 behavioural and "why HSBC/CIB" questions out loud.
- **Day 7 — Video practice.** Record yourself answering 5–6 §8 prompts in ~2 min each from **3-bullet notes, not a script**. Watch back for structure, eye contact, pace. Do the new-team-introduction question (#2) and a macro-event question (#5).
- **Day 8 — Written email + numeracy.** Practise a ≤3,000-char "should we invest in X" email (acknowledge → prioritise → recommend → next step), typed live. Drill percentage-change/ratio/table questions with your calculator.
- **Day 9 — Full dry run** on the Preparation Plus portal; do the practice questions in the real interface; fix any tech/lighting/audio issues.
- **Day 10 — Sit it** when fresh, in a quiet, well-lit room, on your home connection, one device, calculator/pen/paper ready. Do the Video Set-Up warm-up properly. Then submit.

What I could not verify

- Whether HSBC uses **AI-assisted or purely human** video scoring (Cappfinity supports both; HSBC states no automated *decisions*) [\[9\]](#)[\[1\]](#).
- Exact **recorded-video re-record** policy and whether a half-finished video tile can be resumed [\[8\]](#).
- Whether recruiters see a **numeric rank** vs pass/fail; the "**10% pass**" figure (single-source) [\[41\]](#).
- Exact **section names/counts** — reverse-engineered by prep sites and tailored by HSBC; your tiles may differ.
- Which sitting the **calculator** requirement maps to, and whether the **G7 Summit** scenario is still current.
- Full body text of Cappfinity's **integrity-feature pages** (JavaScript-rendered; confirmed by title/snippet only) [\[11\]](#)[\[12\]](#)[\[13\]](#).

- **Candidate forums** (Reddit, WSO, The Student Room, Glassdoor, YouTube) were 403/login/captcha-gated — quotes are via search snippets, not full pages.

Source list (grouped by reliability)

Tier 1 — Official (HSBC & Cappfinity)

1. HSBC — *Application hints and tips* (AI-use policy; STAR; "no automated decisions... all decisions by our hiring team") — <https://www.hsbc.com/careers/application-hints-and-tips>
2. HSBC — *Application guide* (students & graduates; assessment formats/timing) — <https://www.hsbc.com/careers/students-and-graduates/application-guide>
3. HSBC — *Insight programmes* (purpose/fast-track feeder) — <https://www.hsbc.com/careers/students-and-graduates/insight-programmes>
4. HSBC — *Corporate & Institutional Banking* business area — <https://www.hsbc.com/careers/our-business-areas-and-teams/corporate-and-institutional-banking>
5. HSBC — reorganisation completion news release (2024) — <https://www.hsbc.com/news-and-views/news/media-releases/2024/hsbc-announces-completion-of-next-stage-of-global-reorganisation>
6. HSBC — simplified organisational structure release (22 Oct 2024, PDF) — <https://www.hsbc.com/-/files/hsbc/media/media-release/2024/241022-hsbc-simplified-organisational-structure-to-accelerate-strategic-execution.pdf>
7. HSBC — Applicant Privacy Notice (monitoring/consequences) — <https://www.hsbc.com/appendices/ApplicantPrivacyNotice-Generic.pdf>
8. Cappfinity — Device Requirements for Online Assessments (Video Set-Up Tile / Warm-Up; browser/webcam reqs) — <https://capphelpdesk.zendesk.com/hc/en-us/articles/25465900866589-Device-Requirements-for-Online-Assessments>
9. Cappfinity — Video Interview product ("AI-assisted scoring... or human-led evaluation") — <https://cappfinity.com/solutions/for-talent-leaders/assessments/video-interview/>
10. Cappfinity — Task-Based Simulation product — <https://cappfinity.com/solutions/for-talent-leaders/assessments/task-based-simulation/>
11. Cappfinity — Integrity Features hub (Camera-On, Copy Prevention) — <https://cappfinity.com/integrity-features/>
12. Cappfinity — Integrity Dashboard ("highlights behaviour indicative of AI model use") — <https://cappfinity.com/our-products/integrity-dashboards/>

13. Cappfinity — white paper: ChatGPT & Talent Assessment (multi-layer defence) — https://cappfinity.com/white_paper/chatgpt-and-talent-assessment-the-cappfinity-multi-layer-defence-for-cheating-prevention-deterrence-and-detection/
14. Cappfinity — Preparation Hub FAQs (return-later; practice first) — <https://hub.preparationplus.com/faqs>
15. Cappfinity — public practice demonstration — <https://practice.cappassessments.com/>
16. Cappfinity — *The Scientific Origins of Skills & Strengths*, Edition 8 (2024) — https://files.strengthsprofile.com/Deployable/LocalizableResources/en-gb/Resources/Edition8CappfinitySkillsSeries-ScientificOriginasofSkillsandStrengths_UK.pdf

Tier 2 — Industry / prep guides (secondary; commercial bias; 2025–2026)

17. JobTestPrep — HSBC Assessment Centre / Job Simulation (4 micro-exercises, 15 Qs, G7, 3,000-char email) — <https://www.jobtestprep.co.uk/hsbc-assessment-centre>
18. JobTestPrep — HSBC Online Immersive Assessment — <https://www.jobtestprep.co.uk/hsbc-online-immersive-assessment>
19. GraduatesFirst — HSBC Job Simulation (2,500–3,000 char email; formats) — <https://www.graduatesfirst.com/hsbc-job-simulation>
20. GraduatesFirst — Cappfinity publisher guide (time recorded/factored) — <https://www.graduatesfirst.com/aptitude-tests-publishers/cappfinity>
21. GraduatesFirst — HSBC interviews (video) — <https://www.graduatesfirst.com/hsbc-interviews>
22. Psychometric Success — HSBC Online Job Simulation (video 2+2; email; structure) — <https://psychometric-success.com/aptitude-tests/test-types/hsbc-online-job-simulation>
23. Practice Aptitude Tests — HSBC assessments (accuracy+time scoring; stages) — <https://www.practiceaptitudetests.com/top-employer-profiles/hsbc-assessments/>
24. Practice Aptitude Tests — Cappfinity publisher (strengths twice-asked; adaptive) — <https://www.practiceaptitudetests.com/testing-publishers/cappfinity/>
25. Intervyo — Cappfinity guide (multi-dimensional scoring; success profile; consistency) — <https://www.intervyo.co.uk/assessments/cappfinity>
26. AptitudePrep — HSBC Simulate assessment (client-brochure SJT; sliders) — <https://www.aptitudeprep.com/hsbc-simulate-assessment/>
27. TestSolve — HSBC (data pack; effective/ineffective SJT; calculator note) — <https://www.testsolve.ai/companies/hsbc/>
28. AssessmentCentreHQ — HSBC Job Simulation (micro-exercises; investors) — <https://www.assessmentcentrehq.com/hsbc-job-simulation-assessment/>
29. Fintest — HSBC (job-sim breakdown; sample items) — <https://www.fintest.io/employers/hsbc/>

30. Practice Reasoning Tests — HSBC Online Job Simulation (tiles; results) — <https://www.practicereasoningtests.com/hsbc-online-job-simulation-assessment>
31. Ophyai — HSBC interview guide (values-mapped examples) — <https://ophyai.com/blog/company-guides/hsbc-interview-guide>
32. MockQuestions — HSBC HireVue (30-question bank; retail-flavoured) — <https://www.mockquestions.com/company/HSBC+Bank/HireVue/>
33. Indeed — 37 HSBC interview questions — <https://in.indeed.com/career-advice/interviewing/hsbc-interview-questions>
34. Wall Street Oasis — "Why HSBC" resource — <https://www.wallstreetoasis.com/resources/interviews/why-hsbc>
35. techinterview.org — HSBC (Markets tech/strats context) — <https://www.techinterview.org/companies/hsbc/>

Tier 3 — Genuine candidate voice (gated; snippet-only or unopened)

36. Glassdoor — genuine job-simulation description (video + email), ref QTN_2429388 — <https://www.glassdoor.com/Interview/HSBC-Interview-Questions-E3482.htm>
37. Wall Street Oasis — HSBC interview hub (427 entries) — <https://www.wallstreetoasis.com/company/hsbc/interview>
38. Wall Street Oasis — HSBC Markets HireVue thread (macro/situational prompts) — <https://www.wallstreetoasis.com/forum/trading/hsbc-markets-hirevue>
39. Wall Street Oasis — HSBC Job Simulation (no feedback; timelines) — <https://www.wallstreetoasis.com/forum/investment-banking/hsbc-job-simulation>
40. Wall Street Oasis — HSBC IBTM Graduate Insight Programme (London) — <https://www.wallstreetoasis.com/forum/investment-banking/hsbc-investment-banking-trading-and-markets-graduate-insight-programme>
41. The Student Room — HSBC Job simulation, finance graduate 2024 (new-team prompt; invest-email; "10% pass") — <https://www.thestudentroom.co.uk/showthread.php?t=7453447>
42. The Student Room — HSBC Graduate Insight Programme 2025 (IB, Trading & Markets) — <https://www.thestudentroom.co.uk/showthread.php?t=7611921>
43. The Student Room — HSBC summer internship job simulation (2025/26) — <https://www.thestudentroom.co.uk/showthread.php?t=7627492>
44. Glassdoor — HSBC Global Markets interview questions — https://www.glassdoor.com/Interview/HSBC-Global-Markets-Interview-Questions-EI_IE3482.0,4_KO5,19.htm
45. HigherIn — HSBC CIB Spring Insight review (commercial-awareness advice) — <https://higherin.com/review/19409/>

46. YouTube — "Pass the HSBC Interview 2025 | HireVue" (title only; not retrievable) — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cfaeKGm5zL4>

Tier 4 — Context (CIB reorganisation & strategy)

47. East & Partners — "HSBC splits into four" — <https://eastandpartners.com/news/hsbc-splits-into-four/>
48. The Global Treasurer — HSBC restructuring to navigate the East–West divide (22 Oct 2024) — <https://www.theglobaltreasurer.com/2024/10/22/hsbc-unveils-global-restructuring-to-navigate-east-west-divide/>
49. Investing.com — HSBC weighs combining commercial & investment bank to cut costs — <https://www.investing.com/news/stock-market-news/hsbc-weighs-combining-commercial-investment-bank-to-shed-costs-bloomberg-reports-3607153>

Compiled 10 August 2026 from the sources above. Labels reflect the evidence at that date; HSBC's process changes frequently, so treat the on-screen instructions in your own assessment and your invitation email as authoritative, and re-verify anything time-sensitive.

Self-contained briefing · rendered from `hsbc-assessment-briefing.md` · 8 August 2026. Reliability labels reflect the evidence at that date; HSBC's process changes frequently.